DOWNLOAD & RESTORE ADVENTUREWORKSDW2025

CDU
Cloud And Data Universe

Step-by-Step Guide to Download and Restore AdventureWorksDW2025 in SQL Server

1 DOWNLOAD ADVENTUREWORKSDW2025

Open the Microsoft Learn page:
Official Microsoft AdventureWorks Downloads

AdventureWorks Sample Databases

Locate the table that lists the available databases and select:

AdventureWorksDW2025.bak

Alternatively, you can browse the official Microsoft SQL Server Samples repository:
Microsoft SQL Server Samples (GitHub)

Download: AdventureWorksDW2025.bak

3 COPY THE BACKUP FILE

After downloading,
Copy the file to your SQL Server Backup folder.
Typical locations are:

SQL Server 2025

C:\Program Files\Microsoft SQL Server\MSSQL17.MSSQLSERVER\MSSQL\Backup

SQL Server 2022

C:\Program Files\Microsoft SQL Server\MSSQL16.MSSQLSERVER\MSSQL\Backup

The exact folder depends on your SQL Server version and instance name.

4 OPEN SQL SERVER MANAGEMENT STUDIO

Launch
SQL Server Management Studio (SSMS)

Connect to your SQL Server instance.

Example

- localhost
- .\SQLEXPRESS
- DESKTOP-XXXXXX

5 OPEN RESTORE DATABASE

In Object Explorer

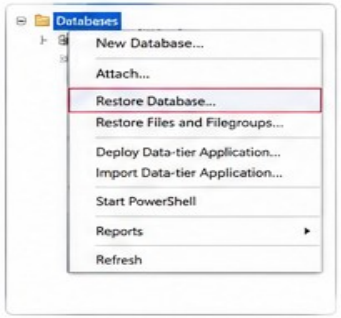
Databases

↓

Right Click

↓

Restore Database...

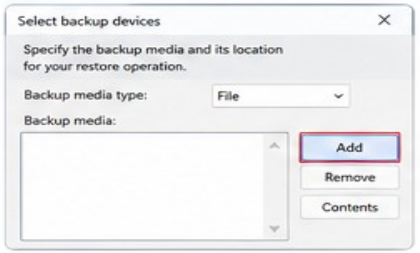


6 SELECT DEVICE

Choose
Source
Device

Click ...

Then click
Add

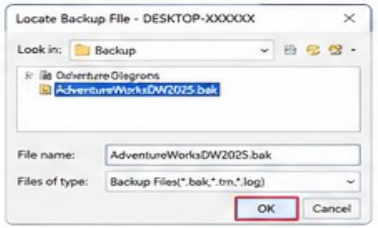


7 SELECT THE BACKUP FILE

Browse to
AdventureWorksDW2025.bak

Select it

Click
OK



The backup set should now appear.

8 CHOOSE THE DESTINATION DATABASE

SSMS automatically detects
AdventureWorksDW2025

If it doesn't, type
AdventureWorksDW2025



9 RESTORE

Simply click OK

SQL Server restores the database.

When complete, you should see

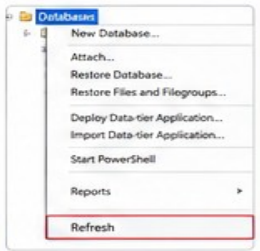
Database 'AdventureWorksDW2025' restored successfully.

10 REFRESH DATABASES

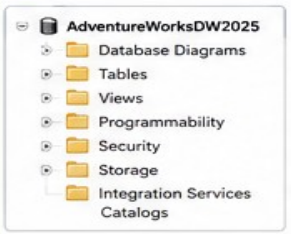
Right-click
Databases

Click
Refresh

You should now see
AdventureWorksDW2025



11 EXPAND THE DATABASE



Expand
Tables

You will find tables like

- DimCustomer
- DimProduct
- DimDate
- FactInternetSales
- FactResellerSales

12 TEST THE DATABASE

Open a New Query window.

Run

```
USE AdventureWorksDW2025;
GO
SELECT TOP 10 *
FROM dbo.DimCustomer;
```

You should see customer records.

Results | Messages

	CustomerKey	GeographyKey	CustomerAlternateKey
1	1	298	AW00011000
2	2	308	AW00011001
3	3	164	AW00011002
4	4	224	AW00011003
5	5	166	AW00011004
6	6	304	AW00011005
7	7	148	AW00011006
8	8	294	AW00011007
9	9	180	AW00011008
10	10	290	AW00011009

13 VIEW ALL TABLES

```
USE AdventureWorksDW2025;
GO
SELECT name
FROM sys.tables
ORDER BY name;
```

	name
1	DimAccount
2	DimCustomer
3	DimCurrency
4	DimDate
5	DimDepartmentGroup
...	...

AdventureWorksDW2025 is a sample data warehouse database provided by Microsoft.
Use it to learn SQL, data warehousing, star schema, reporting, and analytics.

Helpful for learning:
JOINs, Aggregations, Star Schema, ETL, Reporting and more!

You are all set!
Happy Learning!